

Rating: 8.5/10
 Developer: Capcom
 Publisher: Capcom
 Platforms: PC, Xbox 360,
 Playstation 3

Devil May Cry 4

Cry he will... cry he must!

Rossi Fernandes

For those unaware and wondering how they missed the last 3 chapters of this game, *Devil May Cry* is a hack-n-slash game that once again comes back again to the PC for the second time. You play Nero, and for the first time, Dante!

The game plays by missions that are to be completed one after another. There's no proper story-lined gameplay through the game, but there's a very satisfying heart-warming start to the story. It's not just non-stop mindless slicing of monsters either. There are puzzles on the way to open up gates leading to large halls or corridors of creatures waiting to welcome you. Everyone wants a change, so there's the boss fight. These boss fights are not so rare. They aren't too easy to win, but are still good fun. At the end of every mission, you get a score card for your performance, and depending on the amount of items you've collected on the way, you get to choose from new combos and items. It's not just swords—there are guns, and combos for them are available.

Gameplay is great and there's a tutorial in the beginning that flows alongside the initial storyline, and shows you how to use the controls. Most of the AI is simple, but the attacks are well-timed,

so that you relish the game. Since this is a hack-n-slash, people expect it to get repetitive... it doesn't! There's a good variety of creatures to defeat—each one with a unique and charming way of trying to kill you. You discover new ways to defeat these cute little colourful beings, and over time, you may find even more spectacular ways. It's like trying to learn a musical instrument—sometimes frustrating, but always exciting.

Graphically, the game looks absolutely gorgeous. Users who saw screenshots online, and felt it looked great should know that it looks a lot better in motion. The cut-scenes are some of the best and most entertaining. Sure, they are cheesy as hell at times, but they're still good fun to watch. The levels are well designed too and range from indoors and outdoors and sometimes a mix of them.

Sure the graphics are great but can you run it? It runs on pretty much any decent hardware. An 8800 GT for example can run it flawlessly at 1680x1050 with the graphics turned up to the maximum and FSAA turned on. Sounds have been made well too. The acting has influences from East Asian cultures, and it all adds up well with the cut scenes to form the kind of game that *Devil May Cry* is.

Upgrades in the game come in the form of combo moves that you can do and there's plenty to keep you occupied. Speaking of combos, controls are very good if you use a controller. I used an Xbox 360 controller and it did wonders. Using the keyboard is fine if you just want to get through the game, but if you want some of the more advanced combos, you're going to find it difficult.

Besides, sitting back on a reclining chair and playing a game that is usually destined for consoles suddenly makes you forget that you're actually playing this on a PC.

If you are looking for a game with an open world gameplay, character building and meeting new friends online, we suggest you play *Second Life*. If you want a complete change from FPS games that you're used to playing on the PC, then *DMC4* with its fun gameplay, cool graphics and sound, and cheesy cut scenes is perfect for you.

It earns a well-deserved rating of 8.5 from us, and is a must-play for any one who wants good button-mashing action on the PC.

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